

Shada — Shopping List

4 items to buy secondhand. Estimated £35–83 against a £100 cap. The cap covers bought items only — filament, paint, leather, dye and any make-up are materials and are budgeted separately.

NO LINKS, ON PURPOSE. Supplier links and prices live in the production's Drive, not in this repository — decided 2026-08-01, because listings sell, shops close and prices double, and a sheet full of dead links is worse than none because somebody trusts it. What is here is durable: what to search for, where, what to filter on and what to refuse. Paste the search terms in yourself.

#	Item	Target
1	Vest — fitted, sleeveless, dusty grey cloth	£6–15
2	Waist belt, and a second slung diagonally below it	£8–18 the pair
3	Harness buckles and fittings	£6–15
4	Boots — mid-calf, grey-brown taupe	£15–35
	Total	£35–83

1. Vest — fitted, sleeveless, dusty grey cloth

Bought ×1. Target £6–15. Not started.



THE ONE TO TAKE SHOPPING. The serpentine grain is a WEAVE — a faint irregular diamond lattice you can only see because the light is raking across it. Tonal, never a printed pattern. Ask a seller for a photograph lit like this one.



Fitted, sleeveless, dusty grey. The flank panels lace over it — the vest itself stays plain at the chest.

Search	linen waistcoat grey · sleeveless jacket cotton canvas · textured weave waistcoat · raw silk waistcoat
Where	Vinted and eBay, and worth going in person where you can — this is the ONE item on the list you cannot buy from a photograph. Charity shops and fabric remnant bins.
Filter	HANDLE IT IN RAKING LIGHT BEFORE BUYING. The serpentine grain is now a WEAVE, not a pressing — changed 2026-08-02 — so it has to be found in the cloth at purchase or it does not exist. Online, ask the seller for a photograph taken with light across the surface.

Spec	HEAVY CLOSE-WOVEN CLOTH, NOT HIDE. Fitted, sleeveless, dusty grey. Look for a fine, close, irregular texture — tonal, readable only in raking light.
Avoid	NOT A REPTILE PRINT, which is exactly what the market will offer you, and not crocodile or python. She did not choose it and it must not look chosen. Nothing that looks bought.

2. Waist belt, and a second slung diagonally below it

Bought ×2. Target £8–18 the pair. *Not started.*



The leather to look for — soft, creased, matte, already worn. Note the colour: cool grey-brown, NOT the warm tan you will be offered. That difference is the dye job.



One level at the waist, one slung diagonally below it.

Search	leather belt tan · wide leather belt vintage · mens leather belt plain
Where	Charity shops, Vinted, eBay. Belts are everywhere secondhand.
Filter	Two, and they need not match. One at the waist, one slung diagonally below it. Buy long and re-punch.
Spec	Worn leather, plain hardware.
Avoid	BUY FOR CONSTRUCTION, NOT COLOUR — see the dyeing note. Warm brown as bought is expected and fine. No branding, no fashion buckles.

3. Harness buckles and fittings

Bought ×6. Target £6–15. *Not started.*



Exactly this: plain steel roller buckles, a sprung hook, flat rivets, no plating and no decoration. Salvage, not jewellery. Everything here is load-bearing and everything here is bought.

Search	roller buckle steel · harness buckle heavy duty · load rated strap buckle · industrial salvage hardware
Where	Saddlery and leatherwork suppliers, army surplus, industrial salvage. eBay for job lots.
Filter	Six. LOAD-RATED, and steel.
Spec	Real load-bearing hardware. The Bible calls for industrial salvage over fine modern hardware, and salvage also reads more correctly on camera.
Avoid	DO NOT PRINT THESE. Printed buckles fail at the layer lines under exactly the loads a costume puts on them. Printing is for buckles that are seen but not loaded. Nothing bright, nothing plated, nothing decorative.

4. Boots — mid-calf, grey-brown taupe

Bought ×1. Target £15–35. *Not started.*



Mid-calf, flat, soft enough to slouch and crease. The criss-cross straps are added in-house — buy the SHAPE, and expect to dye it.

Search	mid calf leather boots flat · leather lace up boots brown · slouch leather boots flat
Where	Charity shops first, then Vinted and eBay.

Filter	Her size, and check the calf measurement. Wear is wanted — do not pay extra for "like new".
Spec	Mid-calf leather, flat. Long leather straps wound criss-cross up the shaft are added in-house afterwards, so the boot only has to be the right shape.
Avoid	TAUPE IS A DYEING AND DISTRESSING JOB, NOT A PURCHASE — buy the shape and fix the colour. Belts, holster, thigh strap, boots and the gauntlet cuff ALL read warm brown as bought, and the costume drifts back toward brown on almost every image. It will do the same on the bench. Nothing with a heel, no zips on show, no branding.